

Midterm Feedback and Project Guidance

DAEN 459 Fall 2025
Alexander Abuabara



Midterm Feedback

- Difference between learning outcomes and course expectations → refer to the syllabus.
- Project purpose vs. technical objectives:
 - Many project purposes were too technical.
 - Focused on the “what” instead of the “why”.
- Some missed differences between the project charter and project management packet (see syllabus/textbook).
- Late work policy responses varied:
 - Strict policy
 - Flexible with approval
 - No policy
- Sponsor outreach and coordination challenges → think why, and how to address them.
- Alignment between instructor and TA → please follow up!

Department of Industrial and Systems Engineering

Mission

- To serve the state, nation, and global community by educating industrial engineering and data engineering students to be **well versed** in engineering fundamentals and have the **knowledge and skills** required to design, **develop**, **improve**, **implement**, and **control** sophisticated production and service **systems** in an environment characterized by complex technical and social challenges.
- Throughout this educational process, students will instilled with the **highest standards** be of professional and **ethical behavior**.

Prioritize Consistency Over Intensity

- Sustainable productivity comes from habits, not heroics.
- Don't rely on all-nighters or bursts; build repeatable routines.
- Each repetition is a "vote" for the identity you want.
- Early and frequent repetition predicts success.
- Small actions done consistently beat intense, sporadic efforts.
- Intensity exhausts; consistency compounds.

Practical Tips

- Limit your to-do list to **5 items max**.
- Choose **1 MIT (Most Important Task)** and do it first.
- Create a **“to-don’t list”** of distractions (e.g., email, doomscrolling).
- Circle your top 5 goals — avoid the rest.
- Default to saying **“no”** to protect your focus.

Practical Tips

Effective Principles

- Something beats nothing.
- Moving beats stationary.
- Outside beats inside.
- Social beats solo (even for introverts).
- Fully detached beats semi-detached (leave your phone behind!).

Goals

This week:

- Today: project timeline.
- Discuss sponsor needs and business outcomes.
- Decompose the problem:
 - Diagram, statement, structure, conceptual model.
- Review ISEN folder and areas needing improvement.
- Questions: “New acquisitions?”, “Metadata instead of data?”
- Next: Design constraints → avoid surprises!